

[REDACTED]

Re: "Non-Lethal" Weapons

This is from a rather interesting post on CSI Issues. Apparently, there is an article in the current New Scientist:

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Now onto Non Lethal Weapons and microwaves.

> Though there's a piece in the current New Scientist (don't I ready anything else??) suggesting that infrasonic weapons (using very low frequencies) may not in fact be viable.<

This would be the "Pump up the volume" article that starts on page 37, would it? And I think the part you are referring to is on page 40, where it says, and I quote:

They suggest it could be used for tasks such as detonating explosives from afar, or as a weapon, to immobilise terrorists by stunning them with a blast of sound. But having attempted a few simple trials with a device based on Zavtrak's saser "just in the hope that we might stumble onto something that looked encouraging", they are not particularly optimistic about it's prospects. How do you stop the bubbles from collecting together or rising to the top of the cylinder, for instance? "The theory appears to be there," says [REDACTED], "I just have misgivings about it's practicality."

I come to a different conclusion than you do. It suggests to me that it is the device based on Zavtrak's saser that may not in fact be viable, not the use of infrasonics as a weapon. Consider the following: (source: Nexus[don't I read anything else???] Vol.2/16, oct/nov '93. An article entitled "Psychic Warfare & Non-Lethal Weapons", by Armen Victorian.)

On April 22, 1993, both BBC1 & BBC2 showed on their main evening news bulletins a rather lengthy piece concerning America's latest developments in weaponry, the non-lethal weapons concept. [REDACTED] BBC Defence Correspondent, interviewed ([REDACTED] and [REDACTED] two of the main proponents of the concept. After retiring from the Army in 1988, [REDACTED] and began working with [REDACTED] the Research Director of th US Global Strategy Council (USGSC), chaired by [REDACTED] former Deputy Director of the CIA. In 1991 [REDACTED] issued a number of papers giving more detailed information about USGSC's concept of non-lethal weapons. [The USGSC has issued a wide variety of papers on the Non-Lethal Weapons concept. For example, "In Search of Nonlethal Strategy" ([REDACTED]); "Nonlethality: A Global Strategy – White Paper"; "Nonlethality Briefing Supplement No.1"; and "Nonlethality in the Operational Continuum."]

[REDACTED] "White Paper" recommends "two types of life-conserving technologies":

- [a]. Anti-materiel non-lethal technologies;
- [b]. Anti-personnel non-lethal technologies.

For the moment I will only detail the second of the two, the anti-personnel, amongst which are:

1. Hand-held lasers which are meant "to dazzle", could also cause the eyeball to explode and to blind the target.
2. Isotropic radiators – explosively driven munitions, capable of generating very bright omni-directional light, with similar effects to laser guns.
3. High-power microwaves (HPM). US Special Operations Command already has that capability within their grasp as a portable microwave weapon. As [REDACTED] a Duke University ophthalmologist and expert in laser weapons, stated: "US Special Forces can quietly cut enemy communications but also can cook internal organs." (The Wall Street Journal, January 4, 1993.)

4. Another candidate is infrasound-acoustic beams. In conjunction with the Scientific Applications and Research Associates (SARA) of Huntington, California, the US Army's Armament Research, Development and Engineering Centre (ARDEC) and Los Alamos laboratories are busy "developing high power, very low frequency acoustic beam weapons." They are also looking into methods of projecting non-diffracting (i.e., non-penetrating) high frequency acoustic bullets. ARDEC scientists are also looking into methods of using pulsed chemical lasers. This class of lasers could project "a hot, high pressure plasma in the air in front of a target surface, creating a blast wave that will result in variable but controlled effects on materiel and personnel."

5. Infrasound. Already some governments have used it as a means of crowd control, e.g., France.

6. Very low frequency (VLF) sound (20 - 35 kHz), or low frequency RF modulations can cause nausea, vomiting and abdominal pains. "Some very very low frequency sound generators, in certain frequency ranges, can cause the disruption of human organs and, at high power levels, can crumble masonry" (In Search of a Nonlethal Strategy, page 14.). The CIA had a similar programme in 1978 called "Operation Pique", which included bouncing radio or microwave signals off the ionosphere to affect mental functions of people in selected areas, including Eastern European installations.

I might add that I am not sure of certain figures in the above statements. I copied them direct from the article, but I would disagree with certain things, for example:

VLF sound at 20 - 35 kHz. I wouldn't call this VLF sound, the human hearing range is 20 Hz to 20kHz, with telephones only using the band 30Hz - 3.4kHz. Perhaps it was a typo, I think it should have read 20 - 35 Hz, not kHz. This is the area in which I was thinking with my own designs. If anyone here can verify this I would appreciate it.

I would also be eager to learn if anyone here knows anything about point 5 in the above, where the French government used infrasound for crowd control.

